

Technical talk

Math and Diagrams

Priya Nair ^{1,2*}, Elena García², Noah Williams¹

¹ Centre for Comparative Politics · ² European Institute for Social Data

* priya.nair@example.org

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Roadmap

1. Formalize the decision problem
2. Explain system structure
3. Connect results to evidence

Model

Sequential decisions under uncertainty

We consider an agent that repeatedly observes a state, chooses an action, and receives a reward.

- **State:** $s \in \mathcal{S}$ summarizes the information available now.
- **Action:** $a \in \mathcal{A}$ changes both reward and the next-state distribution.
- **Objective:** maximize expected discounted return over an indefinite horizon.

Modeling assumption

The current state is sufficient: conditional on s_t and a_t , the future is independent of the earlier history.

Bellman optimality equation

$$V^{\star(s)} = \max_a R(s, a) + \gamma \sum_{s'} P(s' \mid s, a) V^{\star(s')}$$

The recursion separates immediate utility from the expected value of all subsequent decisions [1].

Bellman optimality equation

$$V^{\star}(s) = \max_a \underbrace{R(s, a)}_{\text{immediate reward}} + \gamma \sum_{s'} P(s' \mid s, a) V^{\star}(s')$$

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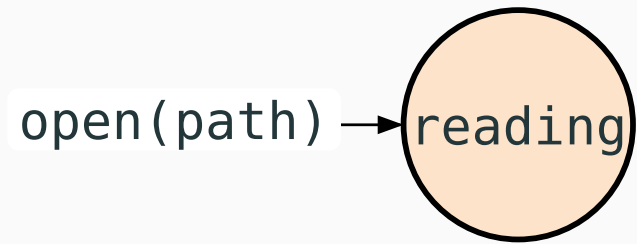
Bellman optimality equation

$$V^{\star}(s) = \max_a \underbrace{R(s, a)}_{\text{immediate reward}} + \underbrace{\gamma}_{\text{discount factor}} \underbrace{\sum_{s'} P(s' \mid s, a) V^{\star}(s')}_{\text{optimal future value}}$$

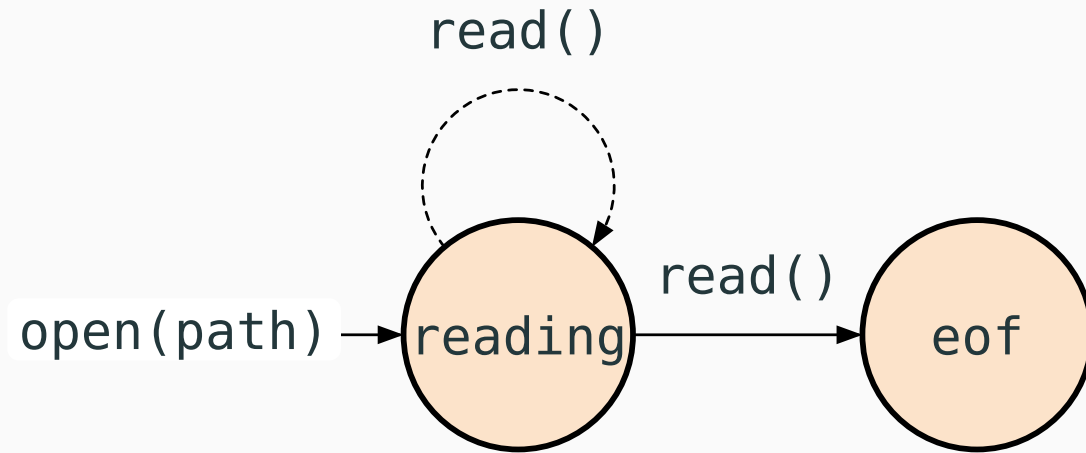
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Structure

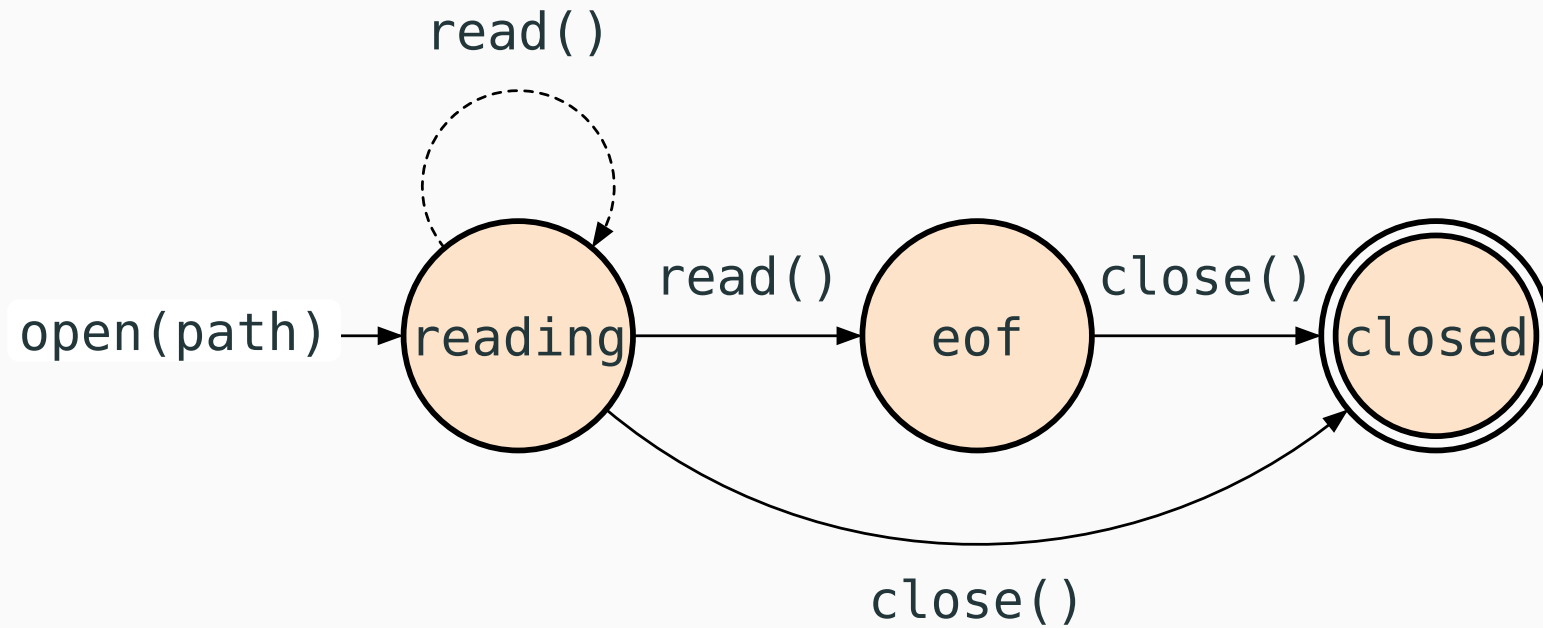
File-reader state machine



File-reader state machine

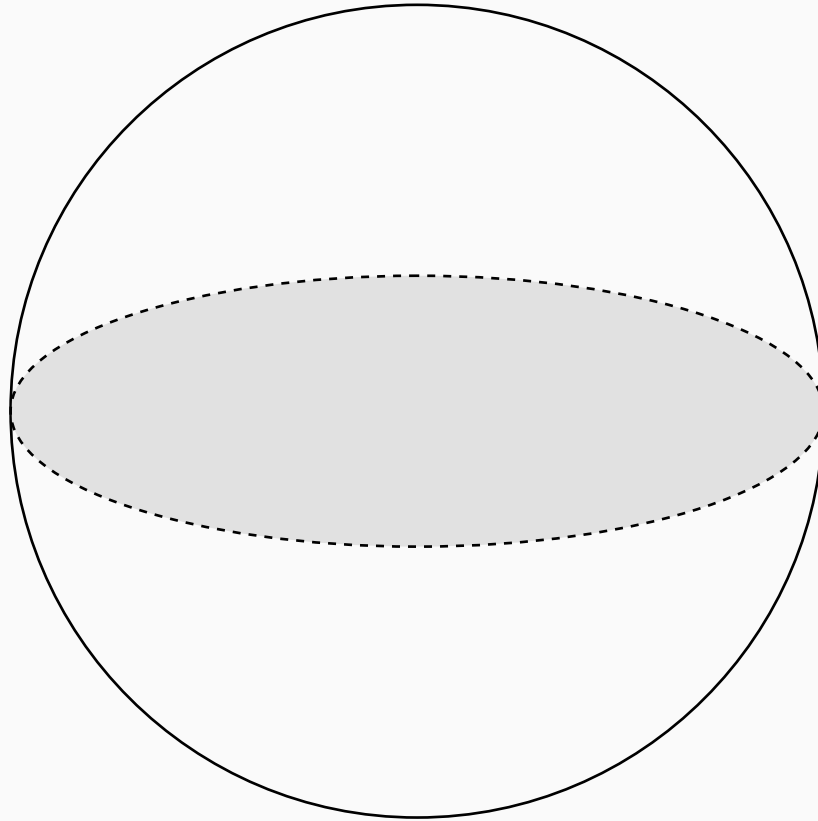


File-reader state machine

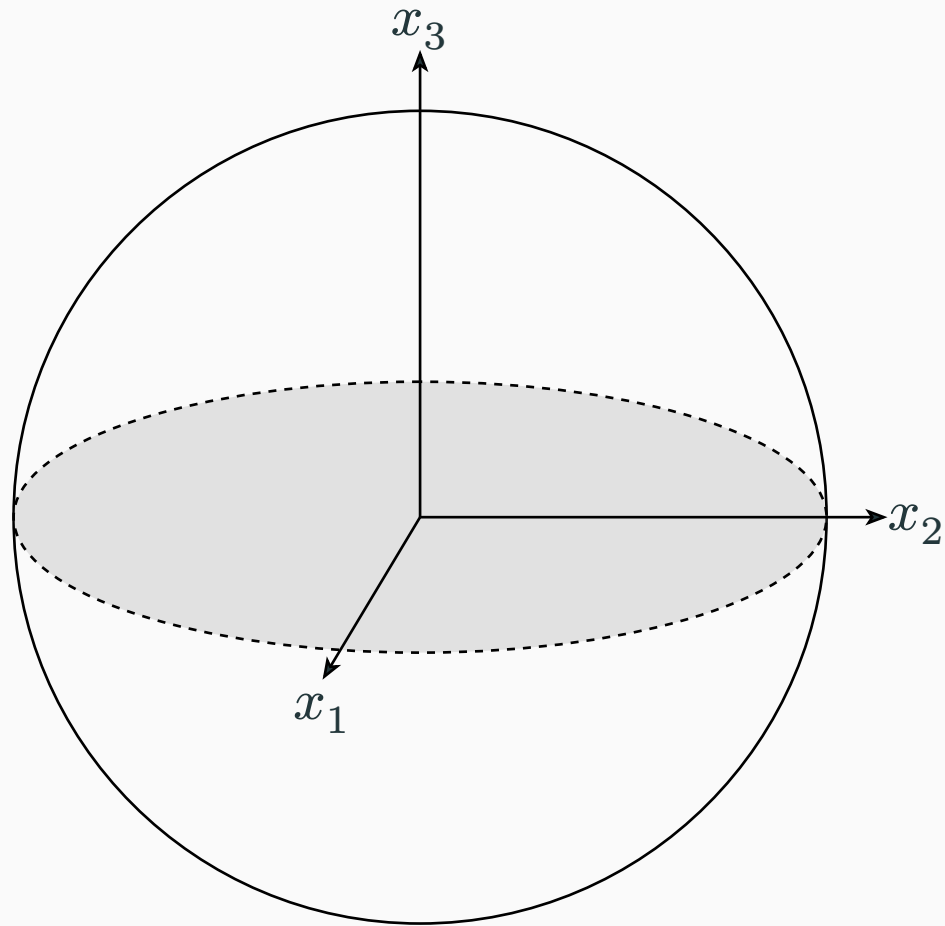


Geometry

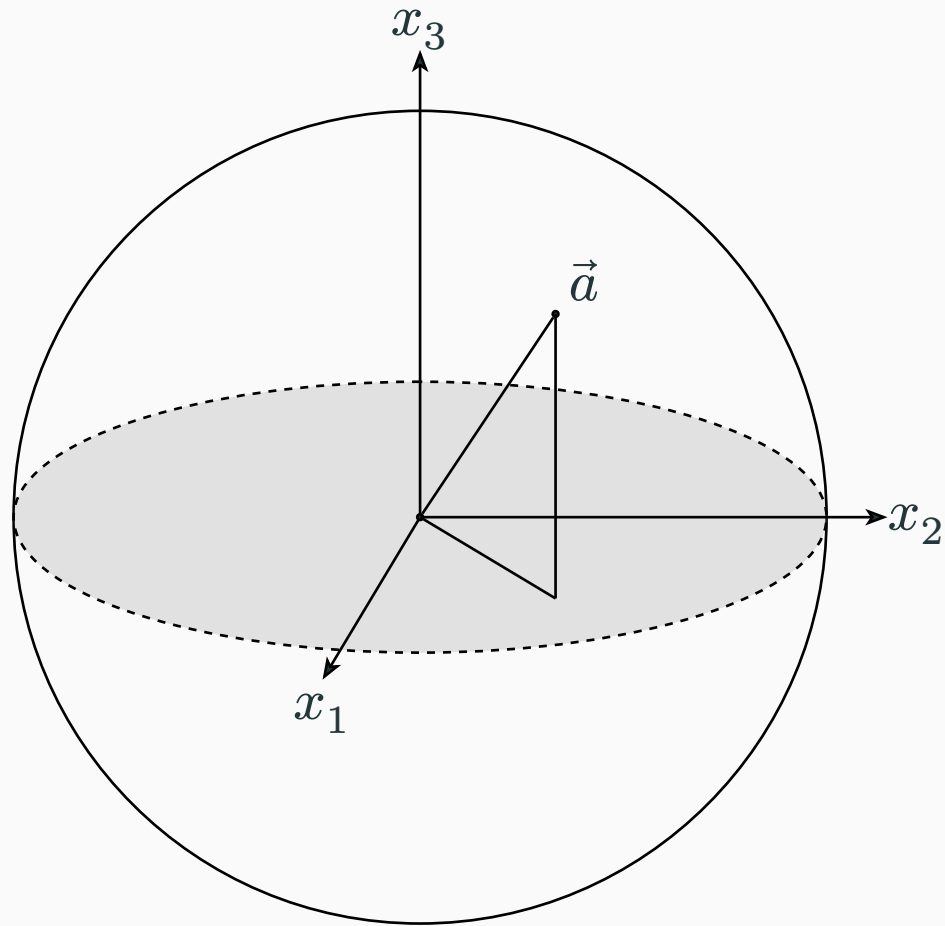
A qubit as a Bloch vector



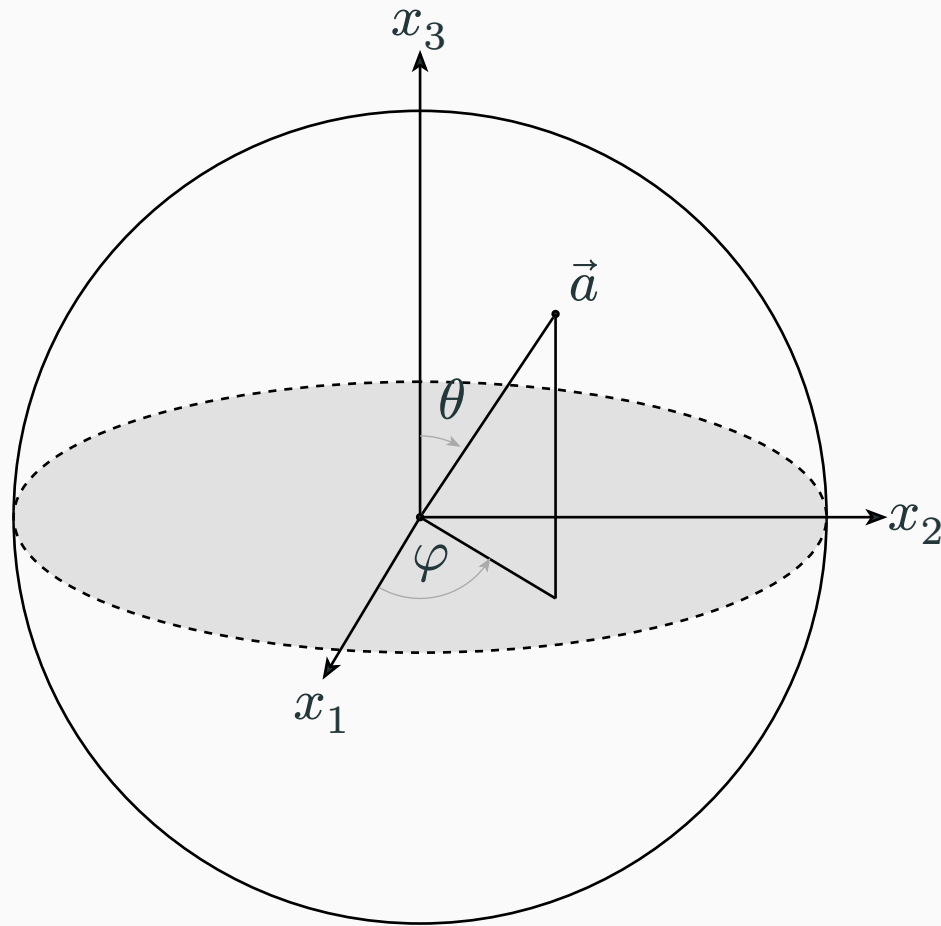
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Evidence

What makes a technical slide?

Include

- a question or claim
- units and definitions
- reproducible computation
- a stated interpretation

Avoid

- unlabelled decorative plots
- numbers copied by hand
- animation without exposition
- citations disconnected from claims

Questions?

References

- [1] R. Bellman, *Dynamic Programming*. Princeton University Press, 1957.